

Category	1984			1992			Average Net Income (\$000's)
	Total Number of Businesses	Percent with Net Income	Rank	Total Number of Businesses	Percent with Net Income	Rank	
Men's and boys' clothing and furnishings stores	1,645	100.0	1	3,410	82.7	57	8.2
Offices of osteopathic physicians	1,001	100.0	3	10,598	96.3	13	7.76
Mobile-home dealers	4,718	95.4	7	6,844	92.3	23	10.1
Highway and street construction contractors	6,812	92.5	8	8,641	56.0	138	12.7
Carpentry and flooring contractors	312,832	92.0	9	497,631	92.0	25	8.9
Offices of chiropractors	18,928	91.5	10	32,501	85.1	49	47.5
Roofing and sheet metal contracting	53,539	91.4	11	98,235	86.9	42	9.1
Drug stores and proprietary stores	14,128	90.9	12	8,324	82.2	60	45.5
Coal mining	717	90.7	14	76	34.2	165	196.6
Drapery, curtain, and upholstery stores	17,508	90.3	15	29,827	79.2	74	6.2
Agriculture/veterinary	16,367	89.7	16	19,622	92.5	22	41.7
Taxis/passenger transportation	42,975	89.5	17	38,907	97.1	11	7.0
Other local and interurban passenger transportation	16,945	89.4	18	30,666	93.6	20	8.8
Dental laboratories	15,246	89.4	19	28,101	96.0	15	15.2
Primary metal manufacturing	4,972	89.2	20	3,460	100.0	1	26.1
Painting, paper-hanging, and decorating contractors	180,209	88.8	21	235,599	91.1	28	7.6
Offices of dentists	77,439	88.2	22	96,746	94.9	16	73.1
Bowling alleys	1,456	88.1	23	1,547	91.3	27	57.4
Offices of optometrists	16,919	86.9	25	12,576	96.1	14	60.1

¹Net income was computed from the IRS's federal income tax data for 1984 and 1992.

Many people ask us, "Should I go into business for myself?" Most people have no business ever working for themselves. The average net income for the more than fifteen million sole proprietorships in America is only \$6,200! About 25 percent of sole proprietorships do not make one cent of profit during a typical year. It's even worse for partnerships. Forty-two percent, on average, make no profits in a year. What about